



AQUARIUS

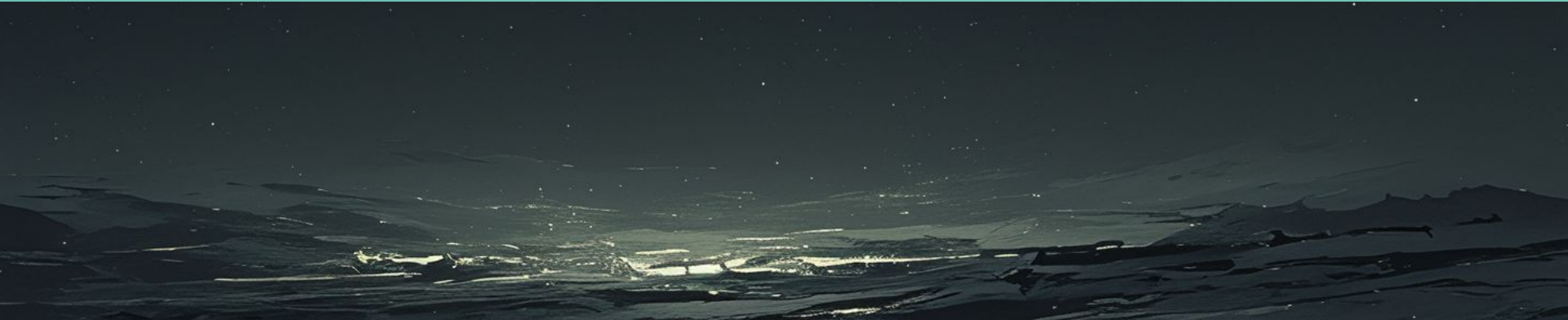
A web3 dApp, built on Ethereum (layer 2)

Aquarius is an App that lets you create a charter, create a currency, create a community, and live in it with your friends, with all records and bi-laws stored securely on the ETH blockchain.



Democracy is broken. But what replaces it? What Bitcoin is to money, Aquarius is to community (and governance).

If capitalism is electricity, lifestyle design is the microprocessor. You can think of it as a high level *human programming language* running on top of the *machine language of capitalism*.



In 2015, Vitalik Buterin
had the bright idea to
add compute to the
blockchain



And introduced the
idea of a DAO:

(D)ecentralized
(A)utonomous
(O)rganization

controlled by its member
stakeholders





In 2018 Court Reinland
asked the question:

“What if we took the
idea of a DAO and
made it a *real*
community, with real
people at the heart?”

One whose bi-laws and
community tokens
(currency), were safely stored
on the blockchain

In this case, the rules and regulations (bi-laws) of
the community, *are stored on the blockchain*

Then anyone could create a community, a bank,
and invite their friends, based on any
ideals important to them





We call this concept...

Lifestyle Design

(A human governance OS update)



Hunter/gather -> Agrarian -> Feudalism -> Capitalism -> Lifestyle Design

Capitalism has made people very wealthy, but it does have *some* downsides

- / Environmental degradation
- / Loneliness & depression
- / Wealth inequality
- / Civil unrest



The good news is...

The abundance is real At the turn of the last century over 70% of the world's population were employed in agriculture. At the turn of the millennium, only 3% were. A vast order of magnitude improvement.





But even so, some young people find themselves...

- / Unable to afford a home
- / Unable to stop working multiple jobs
- / Unable to afford even the middle class standard of their parents
- / Saddled with college debt



For many young people, the
American dream...

Is just that... *A dream.*

In his book, *Bowling Alone*, Robert Putnam showcases the decline of American civic life and how people are meeting up less, going out less, having people over for dinner less and generally less social.

Everyone is lonely...

Let alone for the millions
outside America...

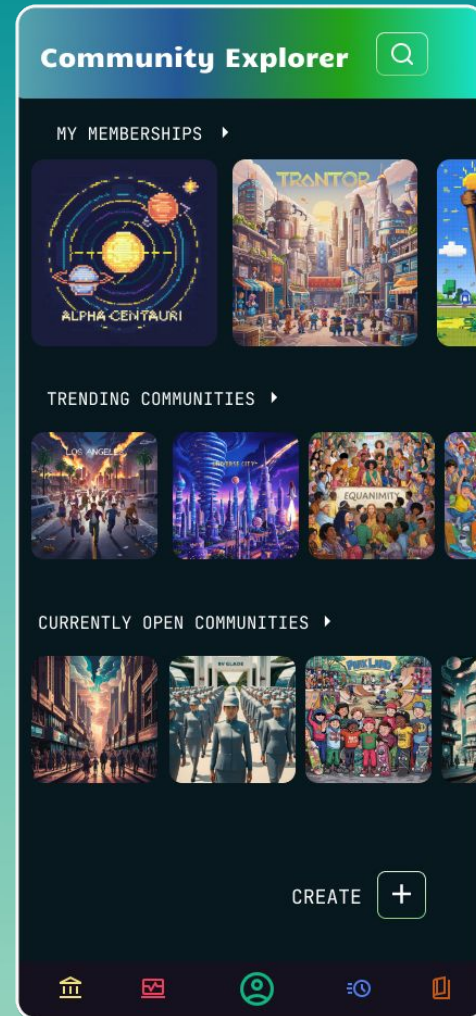
*Experiencing true poverty
everyday.*



What the Aquarius App does

When you open the app up, you're greeted with a Roblox-like interface which shows you all the public communities on the network.

You also have a  button if you want to create your own community.



Found Community

Community name

Libertyville ✓

Who founds this community?

^

A Founder

Several Founders

Charter style?

^

Draft Original

Based on U.S. Constituion

Based on Magna Carta

Based on Blackfeet Tribal Constitution

1 / 3 ▶



Community Creation Walkthrough

Once you sign into the app, authenticating with your Ethereum wallet, you're asked to name the community, declare the initial founders, write the charter or base the charter on a template.

Found Community

By what rule may a member be admitted or exiled?

By a vote of the founders only

By a vote of the founders + members

By what vote percentage?

51%66%80%

Who may propose a vote?

Only a founder

Any member

Any member + a second

2 / 3 ▶



Community Creation Walkthrough

Then you're greeted with a series of questions, to set up the initial bi-laws, such as what style of government, by what rules a person can be admitted or exiled from the community. Who can propose votes and by what metric a vote is passed.

Found Community

Nest this community in the following legal structure?

U.S. Code

International Commerce Law

Define the jurisdiction as?

State of California

State of Delaware

Allow members to join as?

Natural persons

Persons or corporations

3 / 3

Finish











Community Creation Walkthrough

Then you're given the option to "nest" or "style" the created contracts within an existing legal code or country and define a jurisdiction for their enforcement. Aquarius then generates under the hood, legal contracts, like any corporation, using a legal LLM.

Setting up the Community Bank

Next you're asked to define the rules of the banking system, whether you'll allow fractional reserve lending, and set the starting token amount. This will create the community "bank" which is a multiparty smart contract DAO composed of the founders.

Banking Setup

Starting Token Amount

33,000,000

Banking Style

^

Austrian (Strict)
Keynesian (Fractional Reserve)

Allow Arbitrary Token Creation

Y/N

Allow Fractional Lending

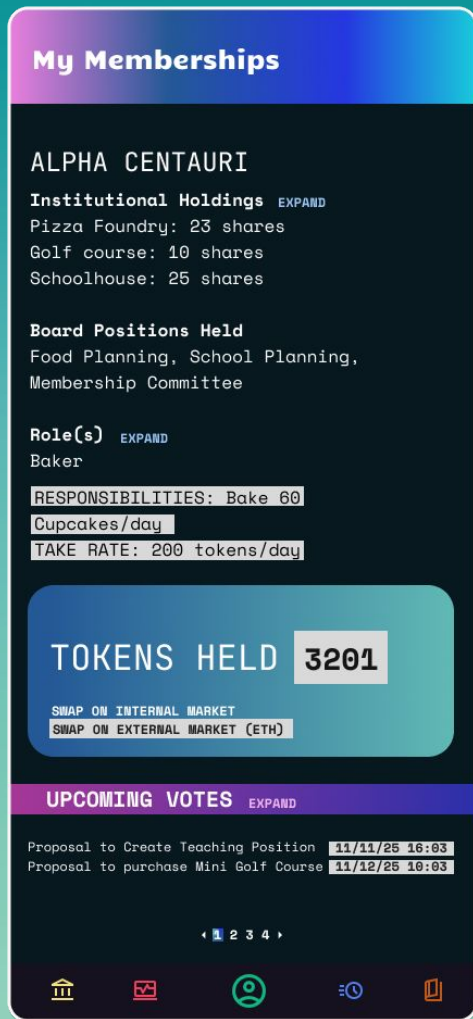
Y/N

Allowed Banking Leverage Ratio

1/1 2/1 4/1 6/1 9/1

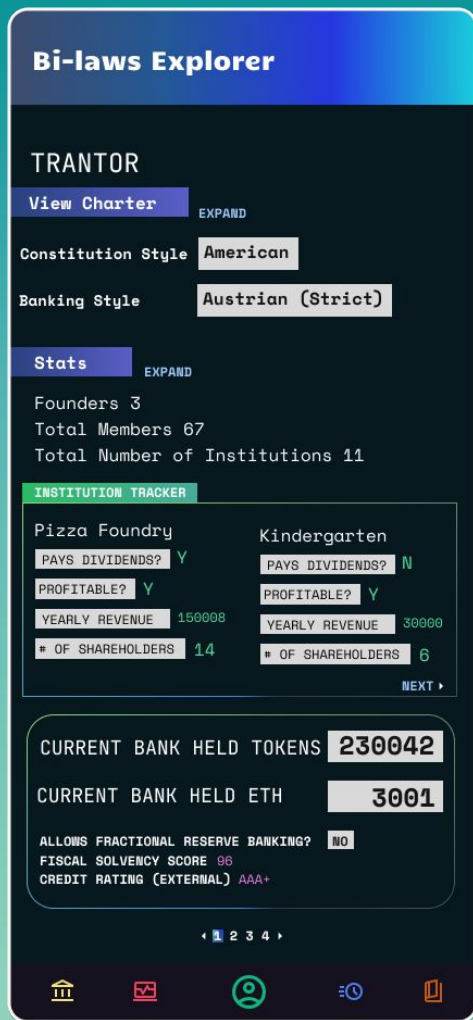
Exploring Communities

Once inside, you can explore the various “power windows” that give you an overview of various parts of communities and memberships you belong to, including your current token and institutional holdings in each, upcoming votes, etc.



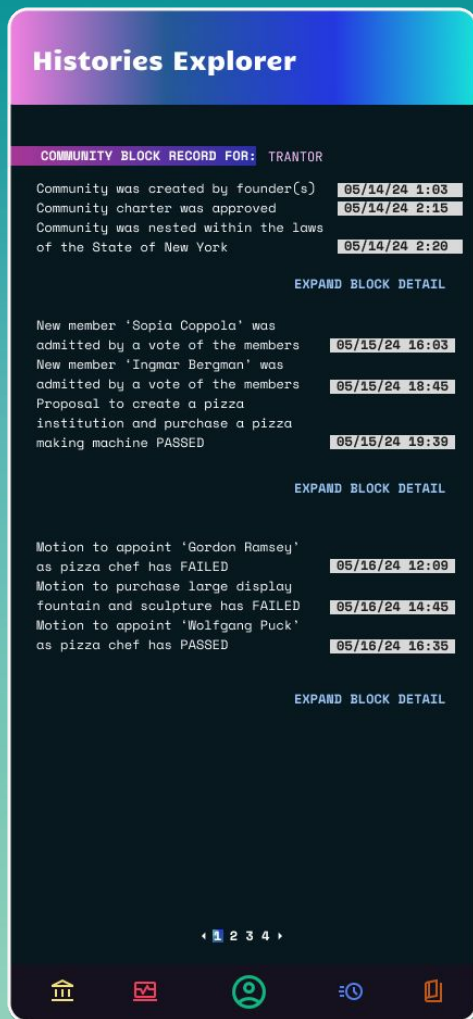
Exploring Communities

Let's say you've just joined a community, you can view its charter and bi-laws, see what institutions (good and services) it offers, view it's financial health, see its total membership, etc., all pulling from the blockchain record.



Histories

From the Histories Explorer power window you can even explore the complete history of how the community came to be including votes of members and dates.

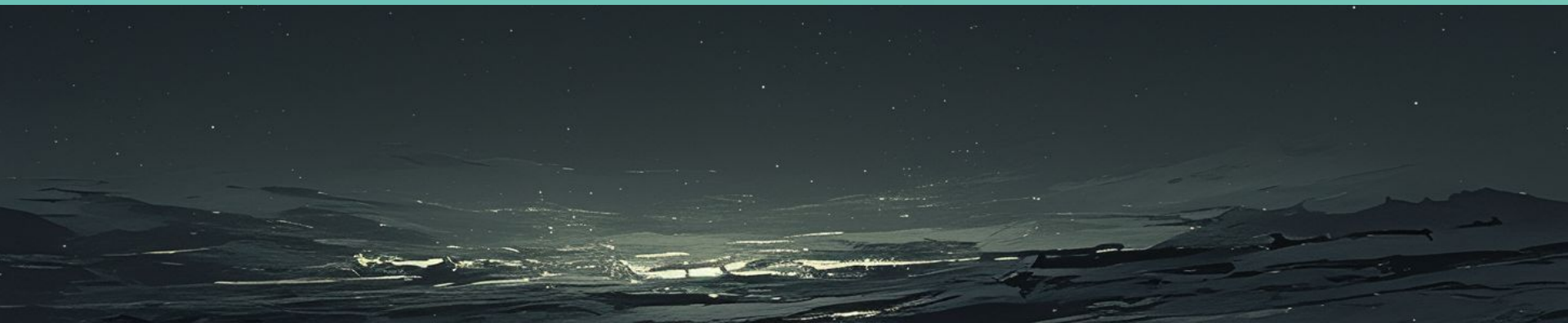


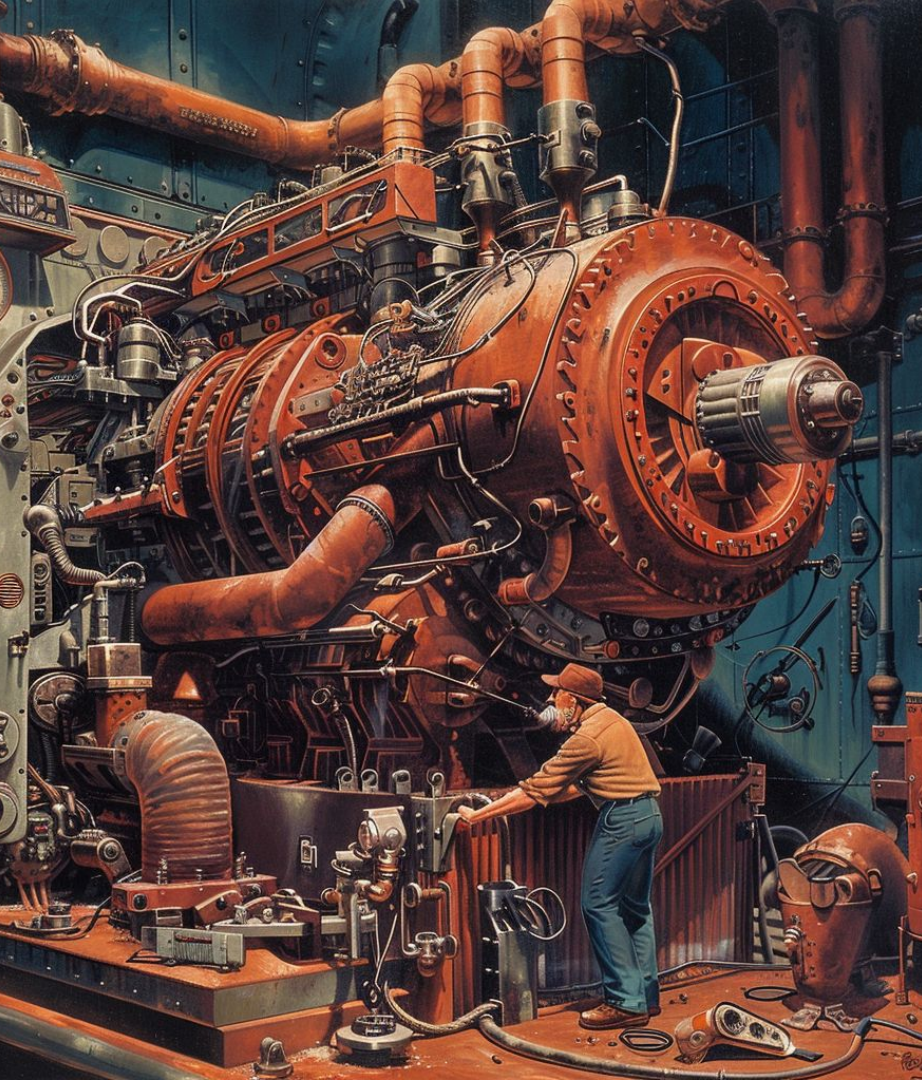
The Seed of a Great Idea

The bifurcation of the economy into speculative and sustainability (*lifestyle*) layers

&

A corporation that trades only with *itself*





Capitalism is one of the most amazing wealth and productivity generating systems *ever built*

But from a systems theory or systems design perspective it's probably NOT the most efficient that could ever *be built*

Normal Corporation

“Outward facing”

- / Trades with everyone
- / Optimizes for profit and productivity
- / Is maintained by people working ever longer and harder

Lifestyle Corporation

“Inward facing”

- / Trades only with its members
- / Optimizes for lifestyle directly
- / Asks the question “How can we all work less for the same or better lifestyle?”

Solving the capitalism “*wasted labor*” problem

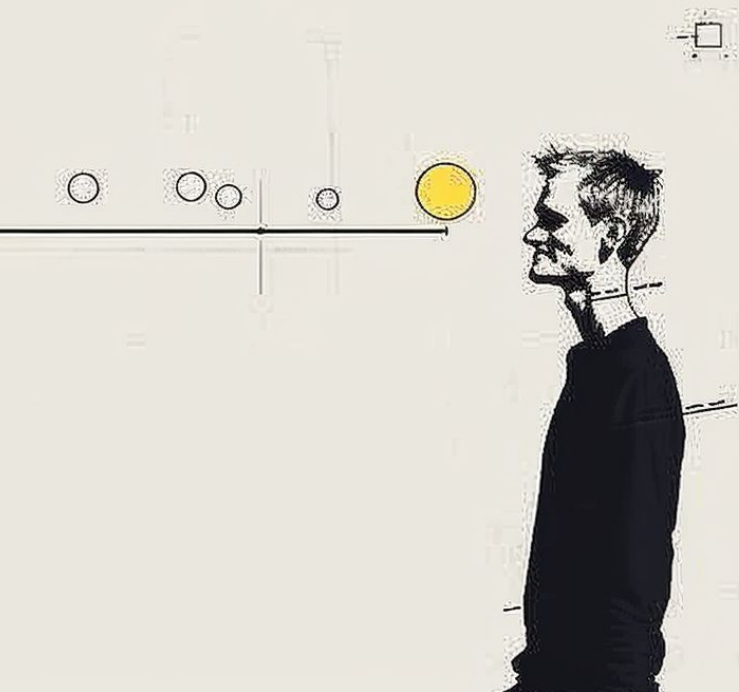
20%

money/labor needed to
create the product and
make it work

80%

money/labor needed to
market the product
and beat competing
products





When Vitalik introduced the idea of proof of stake vs. proof of work, he found he could solve trust with orders of magnitude less compute (and way less energy use)

In Proof of Work (Bitcoin or ETH classic), it used to look like this:

20%
or less

Compute power actually needed to solve the hash #

80%
or more

Compute power spent unnecessarily, failing to solve the hash #
“wasted work”



Aquarius attempts to solve the “wasted work” problem as well as two other problems:

- / the network effects “winner-takes-all” problem
- / the “cold start” problem

It does this by making the vendor and customer the same people, in a (mostly) closed loop, a Lifestyle Design corporation is a “walled garden”



This is Ryan

Let's start with a thought experiment:

The year is 2027, Ryan has just graduated college, inflation is sky high, food and rent are through the roof, and though there's jobs, there's none in his major *"Underwater Basket Weaving"*



Unable to find a job in his major, Ryan reluctantly takes a job in a pizza shop.



However the shop soon mechanizes by getting a pizza making machine, laying off 90% of the staff, and Ryan is one of those let go. Things are bleak.



One day while bored, however, Ryan had an epiphany: “What if we all just huddled around a pizza making machine?”



He called his skater friend Jess, and was like “Hey, I have this crazy idea, do you want to buy this pizza making machine and, like, live next to it? At least then we wouldn’t have to spend so much on food.”



And she was like “That’s ridiculous, but sure, because I’m super broke, but like, where are we gonna put it?”

Actual fully-automated pizza making machine available right now for \$8000



tion Price
0,000

“There’s this abandoned skate park near me. It’s in a sort of run down part of town, but it’s up for government auction.”

The skate park came with a building that used to house X-Games athletes years ago.



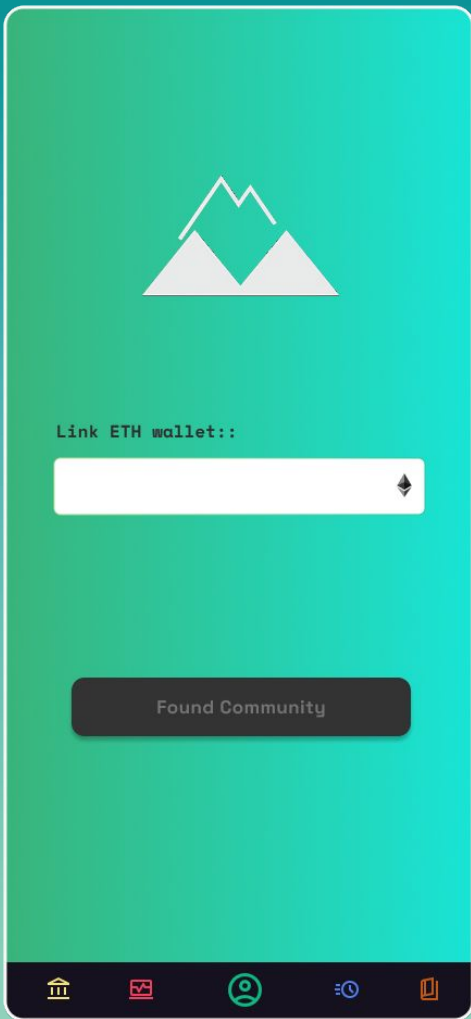
But \$300,000 divided by 2 is still \$150,000, more than they could easily come up with.

So he had the idea, “What if we reached out to our old college skater buddies and people on a few skater subreddits?”



But how to organize it?

They'd heard of the **Aquarius App** through some crunchy friends out near SF, so they decided to check it out.



With the Aquarius App, you can just link your wallet and press “Found Community”

They write up a simple charter with a few simple rules, one of which is “*must love skating.*”



Success!

Ryan and Jess, together with 28 of their friends have just founded their very own community on the Ethereum blockchain!



They now have a skatepark and some apartment units!

The buy-in was set to 2.68 ETH per member (about 10,000USD) in the initial proposal, so for about the price of 2 months rent + deposit in a major city, they now have an ownership share in an apt. and skatepark with their friends.

My Memberships

ALPHA CENTAURI

Institutional Holdings EXPAND

Pizza Foundry: 23 shares

Golf course: 10 shares

Schoolhouse: 25 shares

Board Positions Held

Food Planning, School Planning,

Membership Committee

Role(s) EXPAND

Baker

RESPONSIBILITIES: Bake 60

Cupcakes/day

TAKE RATE: 200 tokens/day

TOKENS HELD **3201**

SWAP ON INTERNAL MARKET

SWAP ON EXTERNAL MARKET (ETH)

UPCOMING VOTES EXPAND

Proposal to Create Teaching Position **11/11/25 16:03**

Proposal to purchase Mini Golf Course **11/12/25 10:03**

1 2 3 4



Community Stats Explorer

ALPHA CENTAURI

View Charter EXPAND

Constitution Style **American**

Banking Style **Austrian (Strict)**

Stats EXPAND

Founders 3

Total Members 67

Total Number of Institutions 11

INSTITUTION TRACKER

Pizza Foundry

PAYS DIVIDENDS? **Y**

PROFITABLE? **Y**

YEARLY REVENUE **150008**

OF SHAREHOLDERS **14**

Kindergarten

PAYS DIVIDENDS? **N**

PROFITABLE? **Y**

YEARLY REVENUE **30000**

OF SHAREHOLDERS **6**

NEXT >

CURRENT BANK HELD TOKENS **430042**

CURRENT BANK HELD ETH **30001**

ALLOWS FRACTIONAL RESERVE BANKING? **NO**

FISCAL SOLVENCY SCORE **96**

CREDIT RATING (EXTERNAL) **AAA+**

1 2 3 4



Stored safely on the blockchain

And each member's holdings can be safely viewed inside the Aquarius App along with the holdings of the community itself.

Proposals Tracker

UPCOMING VOTES

IN COMMUNITY: TRANTOR

Proposal to create a kindergarten institution and appoint 'Emma Stone' as headmaster.
Headmaster compensation 480 TOKENS /day
Attendance will cost 20 TOKENS per pupil/day
Anticipated maintenance cost per/anum 300 ETH

REQUIREMENTS

51% majority required to PASS
A YES vote requires immediate payment of .05 ETH
Each YES vote receives institutional shares as percentage of total YES votes

Vote Now

23hrs 10mins 11secs
till voting closes

EXPAND

IN COMMUNITY: ALPHA CENTAURI

Proposal to create a coffee shop institution staffed by a Baxter robot, managed by 'Dominique Ansel'. Manager compensation will be 25% of REVENUE
Bagels cost 1 TOKEN/ea, Pastries cost 2 TOKENs/ea.
Coffees cost 1.5 TOKEN ea.

REQUIREMENTS

SIMPLE majority of votes cast required to PASS
A minimum quorum of 63 votes required for funding.
Each YES vote receives institutional shares as percentage of total YES votes.

Vote Now

8hrs 15mins 09secs
till voting closes

EXPAND

1 2 3 4



Community Stats Explorer

ALPHA CENTAURI

View Charter

EXPAND

Constitution Style

American

Banking Style

Austrian (Strict)

Stats

EXPAND

Founders 3

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INSTITUTION TRACKER

Pizza Foundry

PAYS DIVIDENDS? Y

PROFITABLE? Y

YEARLY REVENUE 150000

OF SHAREHOLDERS 14

Kindergarten

PAYS DIVIDENDS? N

PROFITABLE? Y

YEARLY REVENUE 30000

OF SHAREHOLDERS 6

NEXT

CURRENT BANK HELD TOKENS 430042

CURRENT BANK HELD ETH 30001

ALLOWS FRACTIONAL RESERVE BANKING? NO

FISCAL SOLVENCY SCORE 96

CREDIT RATING (EXTERNAL) AAA+

1 2 3 4



A proposal is held to purchase a pizza making machine

It passes and with each yes voter paying .071 ETH (\$266) and now holding a share of the pizza machine institution, saved on the community's blockchain record.



The community now has a pizza making machine

It takes a flour input and a sauce input and cheese input. Ordered in bulk the ingredients cost to make each pizza is about \$2.66, or .33 cents a slice.



Later they pass a proposal for a cafe

Crowdfunding the cost of a baxter robot and all the equipment. Again with yes votes gaining an ownership share of a “coffee shop institution” on the community ledger and proportional voting power over it’s operations



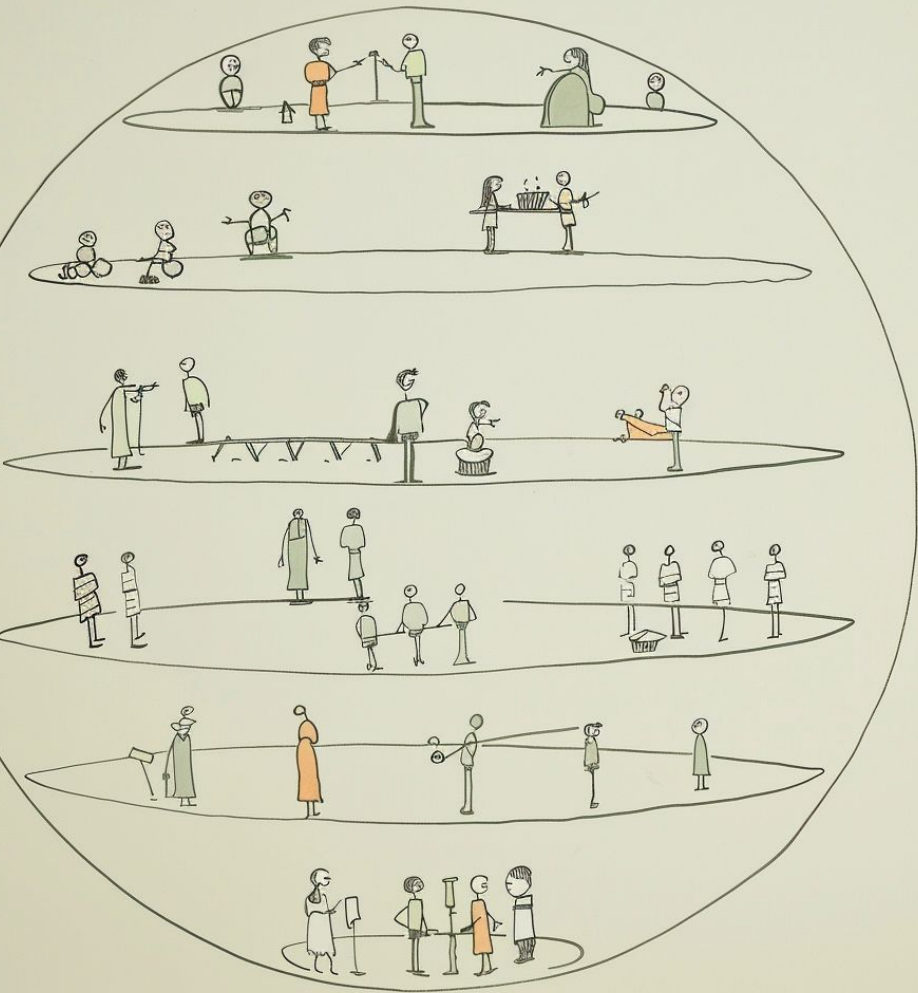
But there was still
much work to do

The building needs
maintenance, so they
recruited a plumber into the
community, and a
carpenter, and a drywall
framer, paying each 400
tokens/day in community
currency.



Roles for members are accepted or declined within the app

And if you ever want to exit a community or exit your role, you can do so within the rules defined, at the time of entering, by the community charter, selling your tokens back to the community or at public auction.



But communities are complicated and sometimes people do bad things

One day a community member was accused of stealing, and video evidence indeed showed this to be the case. The community proposed a vote of exile and it passed. The member was banned from the community. But he was still entitled to sell his tokens and institutional shares back to the community at market value.



Later, they buy a few greenhouses and grow crops with seeding and harvesting robots

All crowdfunded and owned by the members of the community and managed as smart contracts on the blockchain.

Not only do they have enormously reduced food cost, and great fresh, organic food, they also have drastically reduced environmental damage and carbon footprint.



\$3500

Xaver automatic seeding robot



~\$16000

AppHarvest picking robot



\$7700

Shenzhen Industrial automated sewing machine



\$3500

Yiduma 3d Shoe printer



\$22000

Baxter cooking robot

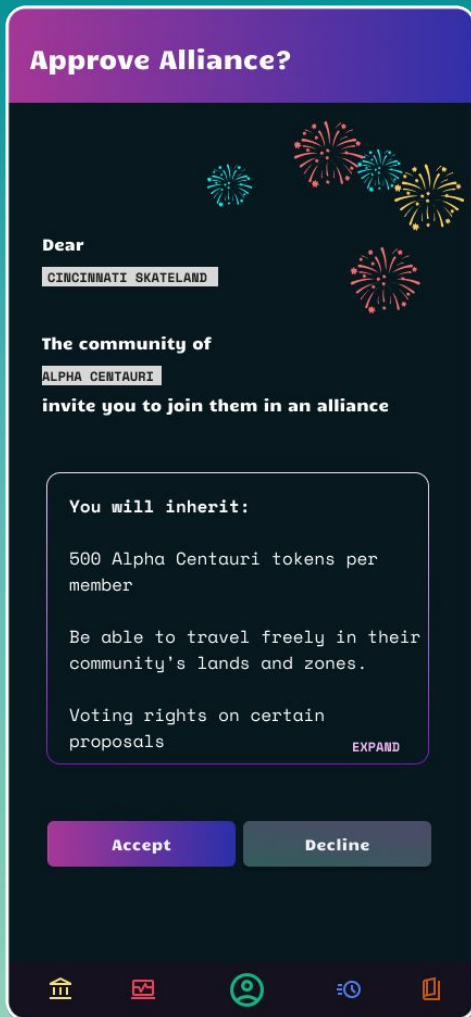


\$1500/ea

Japanese Capsule Hotel pod

They add a clothing sewing machine, a footwear 3D printing machine, and on and on...

These technologies are not hypotheticals - they exist now! Many at prices that may be high for an individual but reasonable for a group.



They even entered into an alliance with a neighboring community who also *loves skating*

With the Aquarius App, you can enter into alliances with other communities on the network, selectively inheriting all or part of their shared bi-laws and benefits, and if they become corrupt or are too top heavy, you can break away from them again via a simple vote.



A few years later...

Ryan and Jess and their friends are pretty happy. They now have .32 cent pizza, .12 cent coffee, \$12 shoes, \$5 shirts and jeans, and of course their own custom skateboards which members make on their own in house.

Not to mention a rent free studio apartment with a skate park and a bunch of cool friends to hang out with. Commercial real estate tax on the improved property is now \$60,000 a year, but with their community of now 60 members, that's only \$1000 per person PER YEAR. Not too bad for suburban Cincinnati.



Why is this needed?

And who would this primarily serve?

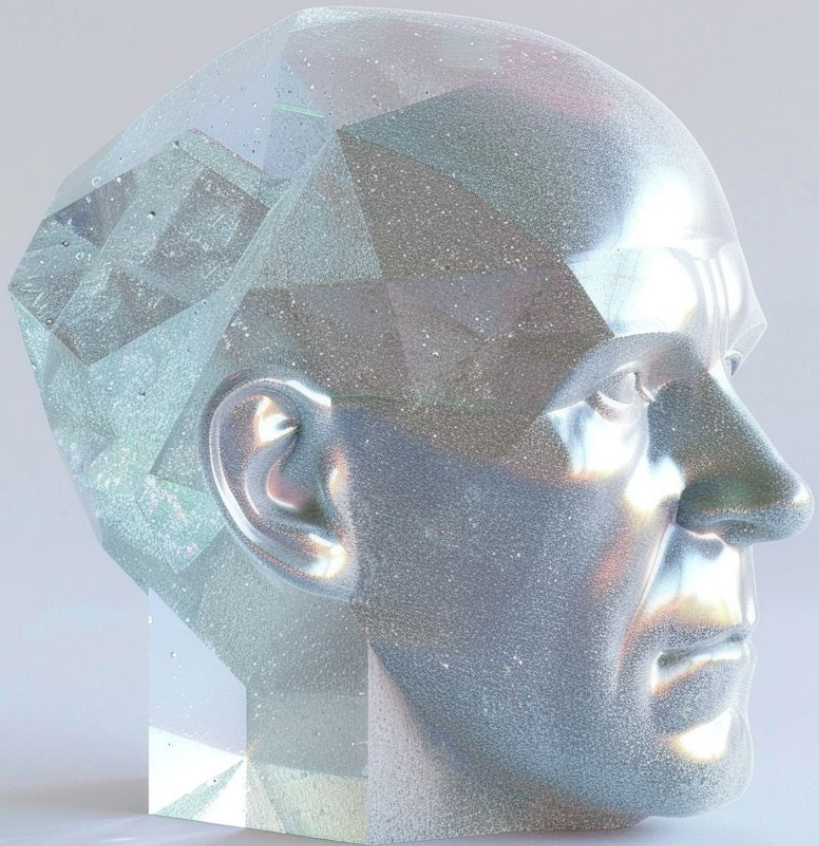
Young people, for one, people who feel they don't have much financial agency.

More broadly, the working class, minorities, anyone who feels shut out or alienated by the current system.

It's advantages would be worth it for the environmental impacts of local production and distribution alone, but I feel the biggest impact will be on mental health - people are lonely...

At the end of the movie *Don't Look Up*, people waited out the last days of the apocalypse by being with *each other*.

And besides, designing communities together sounds really **FUN** right? Potentially the best the fun and energy of both a college campus and a start up - the joy of *achieving together*!



Optimizing for the Right Things

John D. Rockefeller famously said,

"I will pay more for the ability to deal with people than any other ability under the sun."

Aquarius is an app that optimizes *people*.

Capitalism optimizes for *profit*, which is fine since money is one thing people need and want. But it's not the only thing people want, when surveyed, also want:

- / Health
- / Time with their family
- / Spirituality
- Time for hobbies/leisure
- / Giving back/Impact



Radical Transparency: Taking a hit from Ray Dalio's playbook

- / Part of the inspiration from this idea I must credit to reading Ray Dalio's book *Principles*
- / Talks about the "scorecards" every staff at Bridgewater has, even himself
- / It may seem strange or uncomfortable to have everyone's pay and ownership and percentages open and on the blockchain, *but I say it's superior*

**Radical openness =
Radical trust = Increased
speed = Next evolution of
civilization**



The possibilities are unlimited

- / Imagine a “Civilization AI” that tracks community scores and presents tips
- / Comparing and learning from other communities
- / Even learning from ancient civilizations and optimizing
- / Sharing all that data on the blockchain so that anyone could learn to govern optimally



*“And shall pass
away this
vicious age of
Mars, and shall
come the age of
Aquarius.”*

About the Founder

Solo Dev

Court Reinland, the founder of Aquarius, designer of the Aquarius App, and author of "Aquarius: The Book of Lifestyle Design" is a writer, coder, actor, comedian, and filmmaker (I know! Too many, right?) living in New York. He loves people and the planet and is a deeply spiritual person.

I would consider myself a mid-average level technical coder, I have a 132 IQ (I know, not quite a *genius*, but I make up for it with my artistic abilities and people charm, I think!) I am an ENF-J.

I have led two companies as CEO or Co-CEO, one a film production company, the other a multimillion dollar cosmetics company with its own physical products and manufacturing and 14 employees. I fall under "visionary" more than "tactician."

I have directed 5 films and 3 TV show pilots, one of which debuted at Cannes. I have worked with Peter Jackson on King Kong and on HBO's the Sopranos. Have worked for Madison Ave. ad agencies Ogilvy and Mather, and McCann Worldwide and was briefly a Disney intern.

I am the great, great, great, great grandson of American Founding Father Patrick Henry (the "Give me liberty or give me death!" guy).

Daily meditator (Buddha School).



About the Project

Solo Dev

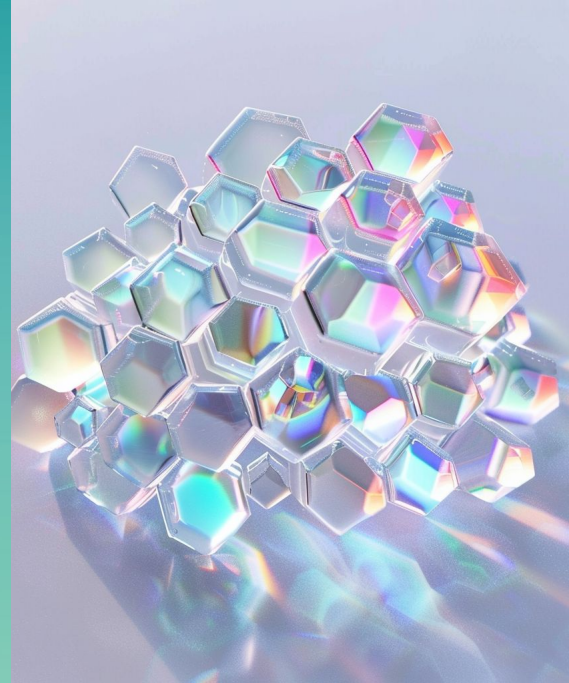
Aquarius is built in Python, using Python Kivy and Kivy MD for UI. It connects to the Ethereum network via infura and Polygon (for now). When I first started I was using Vyper and tried various PK rollup and Optimistic rollup solutions to little success. I began programming back in 2019 but had many other projects in between and many major changes were made to the Ethereum protocol during that time.

The app is primarily intended for mobile with a web app (forthcoming) planning to spin up in some combination of Node.JS and React.JS

It is still in the Alpha/pre-Alpha stages of development. I do not have an MVP ready to show.

I am looking to raise pre-seed/seed funding to continue the project. I am a solo developer currently. There is no team and no capital has been raised. I wrote and published the book and did all coding/design/graphic design, web design and system design work myself, receiving feedback from only one person.

I met Vitalik Buterin at a conference, thanked him immensely for his work and gave him a copy of the book. Crypto journalist Laura Shin also has a copy of the book. You can see the book [here](#).



Thank you so much!
Y Combinator

For your time and attention to this project!!!

aquariusapp.eth